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Early Wealth Building: State leaders, experts to hold summit at UCLA

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Launched under the leadership of the State Treasurer's Office and California State Treasurer Fiona Ma, CPA, through the (State Treasurer's Office Financial Savings for All) initiative — the nation's largest and most inclusive public savings collective — California is bringing together leaders across sectors at UCLA for the Second Annual California Early Wealth Account System (CEWAS) Summit: Building Economic Prosperity for Every Child.

Hosted by the UCLA CalKIDS Institute, the Summit will convene policymakers, researchers, education leaders, financial institutions, philanthropic organizations, social workers and community-based organizations to examine implementation, share research and insights, and identify next steps in expanding early asset-building opportunities statewide.

Building on the foundation of CalKIDS, the nation's largest child development account program administered by the ScholarShare Investment Board, CEWAS represents a first-of-its-kind strategy to align policy, education and community systems. Through this work, California is creating a more connected pathway to asset-building from birth through college and career, continuing to lead the nation in advancing long-term economic mobility.

The summit is from 8 a.m. to 5 p.m. at UCLA University Club, 480 Charles E. Young Drive East, Los Angeles.

Featured speakers include

California State Treasurer Fiona Ma, CPA

Cassandra DiBenedetto, Executive Director, ScholarShare Investment Board

Dr. Daisy Gonzales, Executive Director, California Student Aid Commission

Nayiri Nahabedian, Executive Director, UCLA CalKIDS Institute

Amanda Feinstein, Executive Director, Early Wealth Partnership

Valorie Kondos Field, former Head Coach, UCLA Women's Gymnastics

Jason Ewas, Associate Director of Inclusive Saving and Investing, Aspen Institute

Dr. Summer Sun, Assistant Professor of Social Welfare, UCLA Luskin School of Public

Affairs

Additional participants include state and local elected officials and government leaders, including Deputy State Treasurer Stephanie Tom, San Francisco Treasurer José Cisneros, Board of Equalization Member Tony Vazquez, Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel and Los Angeles City Councilmember Adrin Nazarian.

California has committed more than $2.3 billion across early wealth-building programs to help children begin building assets for their future. Now, 5.6 million California children have CalKIDS Scholarship Accounts, with more than $2.2 billion invested in their futures

California's early wealth ecosystem includes more than 15 local Child Savings Account programs serving more than

212,000 children with over $26 million in savings. Soon, California is launching HOPE Trust Accounts for 60,000 foster youth and children who lost a parent or caregiver to COVID-19, providing $3,000 seed deposits backed by more than $100 million in state investment

More than $77 million in CalKIDS Scholarships has already supported students pursuing higher education and career training.

Learn more about CalKIDS at calkids.org.

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